

Operational Policy

Policy title:	Information System Maintenance Policy		
Policy number:	ODHSOHA 090-012		
Original date:	06/06/2022	Last update:	2/1/2026
Approved:	Kris Kautz, Deputy Director OHA Seth Lyons COO ODHS		

Purpose

The Oregon Department of Human Services (ODHS) and the Oregon Health Authority (OHA) are responsible for the establishment and implementation of information system controls that safeguard the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information systems.

Description

This policy addresses risks related to information systems maintenance and repairs by establishing an information system maintenance program. This policy outlines the requirements for maintenance of information systems and information system components for ODHS and OHA.

Applicability

This policy applies to all ODHS and OHA staff including full-time, part-time, contingent, temporary, and limited duration employees, volunteers, trainees, and interns.

As keepers of the public trust, all ODHS and OHA staff play a vital role in upholding state and agency policies, administrative rules, and state and federal laws. ODHS and OHA are committed to exceptional public and customer service. The agencies are dedicated to maintaining standards of exceptional service and trust staff to do the same. Failure to follow policies, rules and laws may result in beginning a personnel process to consider formal action as appropriate, including progressive discipline up to and including dismissal from state service.

If this policy is intended to apply to contractors or grantees the necessary language must be incorporated into the contract.

Policy

1. The information system owner¹ or designee shall authorize, approve, control, and monitor maintenance and diagnostic activities performed on ODHS and OHA virtual or physical information systems, hardware, or software whether those activities are performed on or off-site.
2. Maintenance is any act that either prevents the failure or malfunction of equipment, software, or systems, or restores its operating capability.²

¹ National Institutes of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-53 Rev. 5 Glossary

² NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5 Maintenance (MA)-1

3. This policy shall apply to all information systems and information system components that are managed by, or managed for, ODHS and OHA including, but not limited to:
 - a. Mainframes, servers, and other devices that provide centralized computing capabilities.
 - b. Devices that provide centralized storage capabilities.
 - c. Desktops, laptops, and other devices that provide distributed computing capabilities.
 - d. Mobile communication devices.
 - e. Routers, switches, and other devices that provide network capabilities.
 - f. Firewalls, intrusion detection and prevention systems, and other devices that provide dedicated security capabilities.
 - g. Associated media such as scanners, copiers, and printers.
4. Maintenance requirements for cloud or hosted service providers shall align with the Statewide Information Technology (IT) Control Standards and reflect the agreed upon service level agreement.
5. The information system owner or designee shall approve the removal of information systems or information system components for off-site maintenance, repair, or replacement,³ and ensure that the equipment being maintained does not contain agency information⁴ by:
 - a. Verifying that organizational information is not contained on the equipment when the equipment has the capability of retaining information.
 - b. Sanitizing or destroying the equipment in accordance with state and federal requirements.
 - c. Retaining the equipment within the facility.
 - d. Obtaining an exemption from the information owner explicitly authorizing removal of the equipment from the facility.
6. All media containing agency data shall be sanitized in accordance with ODHSOHA 090-011-01 Media Disposal Process prior to removal for off-site maintenance, repair, or replacement.⁵
7. Only authorized staff shall schedule, perform, document, and review records of maintenance and repairs on information system components in accordance with manufacturer, vendor, or partner specifications and organizational requirements. Authorized staff shall:
 - a. Send notification of the date, time, and description of the planned maintenance activity to ODHSOHA information system owners in accordance with the ODHSOHA 070-015 Information Technology Change Management Policy.
 - b. Coordinate and follow maintenance activities inside of designated change management windows as required by ODHSOHA 070-015 and the OIS Change Management Process.
 - c. Monitor vendor and partner changes that have potential to impact the ODHS and OHA information systems environment.
 - d. Coordinate with appropriate OIS units to complete activities necessary for repair, dependent upon the warranty coverage of the device.
8. Only authorized staff or technicians shall have unescorted access to agency-owned information systems. Individuals without appropriate access, such as Criminal Justice Information Services (CJIS) clearance, shall be escorted at all times by staff with the technical competence to supervise the maintenance activities.^{6 7}

³ NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5 MA-2

⁴ NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5 MA-3.b(3)

⁵ Statewide IT Control Standards MA-2(d)

⁶ Statewide IT Control Standards MA-5(1)

⁷ Statewide IT Control Standards MA-5.c.

9. All access by vendors for maintenance activities, whether performed on-site or remotely, and for maintenance tools that execute with increased privilege, shall be approved, monitored, and documented including:
 - a. Using remote maintenance, diagnostic tools, and encryption consistent with agency policy and documented in the security plan for the system.
 - b. Employing strong authentication in the establishment of remote sessions.
 - c. Terminating session and network connections when remote maintenance is completed.
10. Following maintenance, repair, or replacement actions, authorized staff shall check all potentially affected controls to verify that the controls are still functioning properly.
11. Maintenance tools shall be approved, controlled, monitored, and documented in accordance with:
 - a. IT Standards and Approved Products List.
 - b. Approved contracts with third party entities.
12. Maintenance tools can include hardware, software, and firmware items such as diagnostic test equipment and packet sniffers.⁸ The use of maintenance tools shall be restricted to authorized staff and comply with the following requirements:
 - a. Have current patches and updates installed.
 - b. Be inspected for improper or unauthorized modifications.
 - c. Be checked for malicious code before use in the system.
 - d. Be reviewed at least annually.
13. Maintenance support and spare or replacement parts shall be available for critical information systems.⁹
14. Information system maintenance records shall be retained as long as the system is operational. When the system is decommissioned, the records follow the record retention requirements. System maintenance records shall include the following information:¹⁰
 - a. Component name.
 - b. Component serial number.
 - c. Date and time of maintenance.
 - d. Maintenance performed.
 - e. Names of entity performing maintenance, including the escort if required.

References

[Acceptable Risk Controls for Affordable Care Act for Medicaid Partner Exchanges](#)

[Center for Internet Security Critical Security Controls](#)

[Criminal Justice Information Services \(CJIS\) Security Policy](#)

[National Institute of Standards and Technology \(NIST\) SP 800-53 Rev. 5, Security and Privacy Controls for Federal Information Systems and Organizations](#)

[NIST SP 800-82 Rev. 3 Guide to Operational Technology \(OT\) Security](#)

[ODHSOHA 090-011-01 Media Disposal Process](#)

[Oregon Administrative Rules \(OARs\) 166-300-0030\(1\) Information and Records Management Records](#)

⁸ NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5, MA-3

⁹ Statewide IT Control Standards MA-6

¹⁰ Criminal Justice Information Services (CJIS) 5.9.4, MA-2(f)1-4

[Statewide Information Technology \(IT\) Control Standards](#)

[OIS Change Management Process](#)

[IT Standards and Approved Products List](#)

Related policies

[DAS 107-004-110 Acceptable Use of State Information Assets](#)

[DAS 107-004-150 Cloud or Hosted Systems Policy](#)

[ODHSOHA 070-006 Disaster Recovery Policy for Information Technology](#)

[ODHSOHA 070-015 Information Technology Change Management Policy](#)

[ODHSOHA 090-009 Administrative, Technical and Physical Safeguards of Information Policy](#)

This policy shall be reviewed and updated at least once every year and following any security incidents involving unauthorized access to CJI or systems used to process, store, or transmit CJI.

Contact

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History

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